



*“Some stories are read once.
Some stories become people.”*

HAPPY 19TH, *DEEDA.*

A STORY IN CHAPTERS, WRITTEN FOR ONE PERSON

Rida. *Deeda.*

A story written in books, movies, and the kind of late-night conversations that quietly change you forever.

The one who stays through every twist.

The Books That *Broke Us*

“Every story has chapters we never forget. The ones that cracked something open in us — together.”

OUR LIBRARY · BOOK I

The Atlas Six

Olivie Blake

“Power is not given. It is taken, and then it takes from you.”

We ended up in a three-hour spiral about Callum at 2AM. You were defending him. I was horrified. Both of us were wrong and right at the same time — which says everything.

“We stopped trusting the entire cast after Part II and somehow that made us love them even more. That’s such a you-and-me thing.”

OUR LIBRARY · BOOK II

Normal People

Sally Rooney

“She had to be what he needed her to be, and in doing so, she had forgotten what she needed.”

You finished it first and sent me three voice notes in a row. I could hear everything you felt and I hadn’t even started chapter four yet. You ruined me for it — in the best possible way.

“We both stopped talking for a while after this one. Not because we were sad — because we recognised something. We didn’t have to say what.”

Frames We *Couldn't Shake*

“Some films don’t end when the credits roll. They keep running somewhere behind your eyes.”

MEMORY REEL I · #0417

Past Lives

2023 · Celine Song

“We didn’t speak after that last scene. The silence was us processing something we both felt but couldn’t name.”

MEMORY REEL II · #0219

Little Women

2019 · Greta Gerwig

“The part where she says ‘Women have minds, and souls’ — you sent it to me three times. I understood why all three times.”

Things We *Actually* Said

“Some conversations don’t end. They just pause — until the next 3AM.”

3:47 AM · A NIGHT WE WON’T FORGET

okay I just finished that chapter and I need to lie down for a moment

I TOLD YOU. I told you not to trust him

the author is personally attacking me. this is a hate crime

we grieve together

SOME OTHER UNGODLY HOUR

why does every fictional man I like turn out to be *exactly like that*

because we have taste and also terrible luck

that is actually the most accurate thing you’ve ever said to me

this is fine. we’re fine. (*we are not fine*)

no we really aren’t but it’s kind of wonderful, isn’t it?

the most wonderful kind of not fine. always with you

Some conversations only make sense at 3:47 AM.

Something I've *Been Meaning* to Say

There are things that live between conversations. Things I wrote in my head a hundred times and never sent. Until now.

Deeda,

There are people you meet and you know — the way you always know, in fiction — that they matter.

You were one of those people. You still are. You always will be.

The thing about being friends with you is that it doesn't feel like something I chose. It feels like something that was already written — somewhere in the margins of a book, between the lines of a scene we both watched at the same time in different places.

You're the person I send the voice note to at 3AM. The one who gets why the fictional grief is actually real grief. The one who doesn't need it explained.

You, me, and Hafsu — we're the kind of trio that doesn't happen twice. But you and I specifically have something that lives in the pages and the frames. In the stories that broke us open.

I've thought about how to say this properly for a long time.

I don't think there's a proper way. There's only this: thank you for being the kind of person who stays. Who spirals with me. Who grieves fictional characters like they deserve to be grieved.

Happy 19th, Deeda. May this year be as full of feeling as every story we ever loved — and may you always, always know you are the best part of mine.

— *always, your person*

Thank you for existing.

*May 19 be the year every story you love starts feeling like it was written
for you — because it was.*



*In every story we ever loved,
the rarest kind of love was never the loud one.
It was the one that stayed through every twist,
every heartbreak, every unfinished chapter.*

*And after all those stories, I realised something simple —
the most beautiful part was never the ending.*

Thank you for being someone who stayed.

Happy 19th, Deeda.

In my story... that has always been you.